

Normalized reference - Standard Selection Questionnaire (SQ)

Crown Commercial Service, UK Government

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Scope

Historic UK government policy note on a standard questionnaire used in a supplier selection stage.

Summary

The document explains a structured selection questionnaire intended to support a consistent supplier selection stage. It describes initial supplier declarations, selection questions and subsequent evidence checks within the policy context applicable at publication.

Concepts and definitions

Supplier selection; exclusion grounds; self-declaration; selection criteria; financial standing; technical and professional ability; supporting entities; selection evidence.

Process or procedure

Publish the standard questionnaire or equivalent approved access route; obtain supplier declarations and selection responses; assess against the stated exclusion and selection criteria; request and verify evidence in line with the procedure.

Criteria

The source organizes the questionnaire into supplier information, exclusion grounds and selection criteria. It emphasizes use of appropriate and proportionate questions.

Responsibilities

Contracting authorities design and communicate the selection stage and conduct verification. Potential suppliers submit declarations and information; evidence is checked at the defined point in the process.

Exceptions

The note permits certain deviations in the selection-question area but places conditions on their use and reporting. Applicability depends on the procurement and legal framework.

Risks and controls

The document addresses risks of inconsistent selection by using a common structure and stated criteria. Controls include declarations, documented questions, proportionate criteria and evidence verification.

Questions supported

What information supports supplier selection? What are exclusion grounds and selection criteria in this historic framework? When is supplier evidence checked?

Limitations

Historic 2016 guidance under the Public Contracts Regulations 2015. It must not be treated as current UK procurement law or as a universal supplier-selection rule.

Source sections used

Source Action Note 8/16; Annex A, paragraphs 1-16; Annexes B and C.